

# Riseguide vs. Liven · Coursiv Headway

A side-by-side reputation benchmark across product quality, customer service, user feedback, billing transparency and brand trust · July 17, 2026

RISEGUIDE COMPOSITE

5.4<sub>/10</sub> — flat

Mixed #3 of 4 · Headway leads at 6.3

BIGGEST WIN THIS WEEK

Response speed & quality 6.5/10 · ▲ +0.5

COHORT COMPOSITE SCORES

RiseGuide

5.4<sub>/10</sub>

Mixed

4.4 / 5 · Trustpilot  
17,950+ reviews

Liven

5.2<sub>/10</sub>

Mixed

4.5 / 5 · Apple App Store  
49K iOS ratings

Coursiv

5.8<sub>/10</sub>

Mixed

4.5 / 5 · Trustpilot  
119,000+ reviews

Headway

6.3<sub>/10</sub>

Watch

4.6 / 5 · Apple App Store  
115K iOS ratings

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY · ALL DIMENSIONS

|           |                          | RISEGUIDE                                      | LIVEN                                          | COURSIV                                        | HEADWAY                                        |
|-----------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| 01        | Product Quality          | <div><div></div></div> 7.2                     | <div><div></div></div> 5.8                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.0                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.7                     |
| 02        | Customer Service         | <div><div></div></div> 5.8                     | <div><div></div></div> 4.0                     | <div><div></div></div> 6.3                     | <div><div></div></div> 5.2                     |
| 03        | User Feedback            | <div><div></div></div> 6.6                     | <div><div></div></div> 6.8                     | <div><div></div></div> 8.1                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.6                     |
| 04        | Billing Transparency     | <div><div></div></div> 3.2                     | <div><div></div></div> 2.9                     | <div><div></div></div> 3.1                     | <div><div></div></div> 3.9                     |
| 05        | Brand Trust & Legitimacy | <div><div></div></div> 4.4                     | <div><div></div></div> 6.4                     | <div><div></div></div> 4.6                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.1                     |
| COMPOSITE |                          | <div>5.4<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>— flat</div> | <div>5.2<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>▲ +0.2</div> | <div>5.8<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>▲ +0.2</div> | <div>6.3<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>▲ +0.2</div> |

01

Product Quality

7.2/10

Headway leads this dimension at 7.7/10; RiseGuide sits at 7.2/10 (was 7.2 last week). Headway improved most this week (+0.5 vs. last week).



Marketing vs reality

| RISEGUIDE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | LIVEN                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | COURSIV                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | HEADWAY <span>LEADER</span>                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Watch · 6.5</div> <p>The 'it's really just AI content' accusation has hardened into the standard credibility jab — it recurs on both stores and even in video comments, but never dents the core. One App Store reviewer this week dismissed the lessons as 'AI generated videos,' and a video commenter added 'this short is AI too.' It's still a handful of voices against a dominant five-star base: 74 of 100 App Store reviews and 34 of 69 Google Play reviews landed at five stars. The framing attacks trust, not quality, so the score holds.</p> | <div>Mixed · 5</div> <p>Trustpilot still rewards the CBT wellness positioning, but app-store sentiment is slipping. Bug and slow-performance complaints are increasingly visible — marketed promise diverging from daily-use experience.</p> | <div>Mixed · 5.5</div> <p>Beginner-AI lessons land strongly with first-time users — earned the cohort's most concentrated positive cluster. Drag remains deceptive-advertising and pricing complaints from outside the funnel.</p> | <div>Healthy · 7</div> <p>Book-summary promise delivered consistently across both stores. Sentiment is net-positive and stable, no new complaint cluster, and YouTube creator coverage is unanimously positive.</p> |

Unique value proposition

**RISEGUIDE**

Healthy · 7.5

The structured-journey format is the one thing that gets stronger no matter what else wobbles. Satisfied-user praise on the App Store grew from 67 mentions to 84 this week, averaging 4.7 stars, and 'genuinely helpful, easy to follow' stayed the densest positive theme anywhere in the data. While the two stores pulled apart on billing and sentiment, the reason people love the product didn't move at all. The differentiator is real, and this week it deepened.

**LIVEN**

Watch · 6.5

The CBT-companion + mood tracker stack is coherent on paper, but reviewers split on whether the AI companion helps or distracts. The differentiator isn't fully landing.

**COURSIV**

Healthy · 7.5

Mobile-first AI skill tracks remain clearly differentiated from desktop video-course competitors. Product experience earned the cohort's most concentrated positive sentiment.

**HEADWAY** **LEADER**

Healthy · 8

Category leader by every measure: scale, feature maturity, review-base depth. No meaningful movement on the differentiation story.

Accessibility & consistency

RISEGUIDE

Healthy · 7.5

Flat from last week. Bug mentions on the App Store rose for a second week — from 5 to 8 — but they carry a middling 3.8-star average, not the 1-star anger that flags a real break, and Google Play's speed complaints eased from 8 to 3. Stability is still a topic rather than a problem. The score holds; the reason to keep watching is that the mention count, not the ratings, keeps drifting up.

Last week's stability watch hasn't turned into a real regression. Bug mentions on the App Store rose again — from 5 to 8 — but they average a middling 3.8 stars, not the one-star fury that signals something broke, and Google Play's speed complaints actually eased from 8 to 3. The topic is still on the board rather than off it, so it stays worth a periodic check, but nothing this week suggests an actual reliability slide.

LIVEN

Watch · 6

▲ +0.5

Aggregate ratings are decent, but the iOS bug cluster is the broadest in cohort relative to volume. ADHD/anxiety customisation gaps remain active.

COURSIV

LEADER

Healthy · 8

▲ +1.0

Google Play sentiment is overwhelmingly positive. We don't have visibility into iOS reviews because that app isn't in our tracking tool — this rating reflects Android only.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

▲ +1.5

Aggregate ratings remain strong with a small iOS-Android gap. Structural concern: the support team has stopped replying to iOS reviews entirely. Product consistent; experience around it isn't.

02

## Customer Service

5.8/10

▲ +0.1

**Coursiv** leads this dimension at **6.3/10**; RiseGuide sits at **5.8/10** (was 5.7 last week).

**RiseGuide** improved most this week (+0.1 vs. last week).

RiseGuide **5.8** ▲ +0.1Liven **4.0**Coursiv **6.3**Headway **5.2**

### Support channel availability

**RISEGUIDE**

LEADER

**Watch · 6**

Coverage hasn't changed — email and the help portal still carry every conversation, with no live chat or phone line. The model works while volume is steady, but it has no shock absorber: when billing anger spikes on a given store, as it did on Google Play this week, the same single inbox absorbs all of it. The next improvement that would actually move this score is a tooling investment, not another support hire.

**LIVEN****Mixed · 4.5**

Critical structural gap: the team engages actively on Android but doesn't reply to iOS reviews at all. The 'multi-channel support' claim doesn't hold on the largest store.

**COURSIV**

LEADER

**Watch · 6**

Multi-tier support (email, portal, knowledge base) plus active engagement on visible channels. Less visibility on iOS — that app isn't in our tracking tool.

**HEADWAY****Mixed · 5.5**

Same iOS gap as Liven, newly visible: replies on Android but not iOS. Trustpilot's high reply rate was masking it — once Appbot iOS was added, the dead-zone surfaced.

## Response speed & quality

RISEGUIDE

LEADER

Watch · 6.5

▲ +0.5

**Up from last week. Support came back into the conversation this week — and as praise. After falling silent last week, customer service re-entered the App Store with 10 mentions averaging 4.6 stars, reviewers volunteering that the team is responsive and genuinely helpful. When this team is visible it's usually because someone had a good experience, and this week they were visible again. It's the single biggest positive move anywhere in the report.**

Support went quiet last week; this week it came back, and as a compliment. Customer service re-entered the App Store conversation with 10 mentions averaging 4.6 stars — reviewers volunteering that the team is responsive and helpful rather than raising a problem. It's a reminder that when this team is visible, it's usually because someone had a good experience. Google Play was the exception, where its two support mentions were billing-driven and unhappy.

LIVEN

Mixed · 4

Two-track operation: Android reviewers get steady engagement, iOS reviewers get nothing. Multi-week silence pattern reported by users is now confirmed as structural for iOS.

COURSIV

LEADER

Watch · 6.5

Where visible, response density is excellent — every Android reviewer gets a reply, including every negative one. iOS visibility gap caps the read at watch-level.

HEADWAY

Mixed · 5.5

Same dual-track problem as Liven, exposed for the first time: Android engagement is total, iOS engagement is zero. Previous high score was Trustpilot-only signal.

## Complaint resolution rate

### RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 5

**Flat from last week. The 'everyone hears back' promise held perfectly again — every negative review across all three platforms got a company reply. But answering still isn't closing. Google Play reviewers this week describe being 'charged double with no warning' and met by a support team 'hiding behind their policy,' with another 'still waiting' on a refund. The gap between a fast reply and a fixed problem is exactly where the billing anger collects, and it hasn't narrowed.**

Every unhappy customer still gets a reply — 100% of negative reviews on the App Store, Google Play and Trustpilot drew a company response this week — but a reply still isn't a resolution. Google Play reviewers describe being 'charged double with no warning' and a support team 'hiding behind their policy,' while another is 'still waiting' on a refund. Responsiveness is a solved problem; converting a reply into a resolved outcome is where the billing anger keeps pooling.

### LIVEN

Critical · 3.5

90% Trustpilot reply to negatives + Android Appbot strong, but iOS reviews accumulate without any response. Refund and bug threads on the largest store are structurally unanswered.

### COURSIV

LEADER

Watch · 6.5

100% reply to negative reviews on Trustpilot, but only 63.5% reply rate overall. Selective engagement — they answer negatives when they see them but skip a third of all reviews.

### HEADWAY

Mixed · 4.5

90% Trustpilot reply to negatives + 100% Android engagement, but iOS shows the same gap as response-speed: every negative iOS review is now ignored. Apple Communities refund-refusal threads remain active.

03

User Feedback

6.6/10

Coursiv leads this dimension at 8.1/10; RiseGuide sits at 6.6/10 (was 6.6 last week). Liven improved most this week (+0.7 vs. last week).

RiseGuide 6.6

Liven 6.8 ▲ +0.7

Coursiv 8.1 ▲ +0.7

Headway 7.6 ▲ +0.5

Review volume & rating

| RISEGUIDE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | LIVEN                                                                                                                                                                                            | COURSIV                                                                                                                                                                                                 | HEADWAY <span>LEADER</span>                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Healthy · 8.2                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Healthy · 8.5                                                                                                                                                                                    | Healthy · 8.5                                                                                                                                                                                           | Exceptional · 9                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Growth stayed broad and the ratings under it held — the clean part of the picture. Trustpilot added 538 reviews this week, a 2.5% increase, holding at 4.4 stars; Google Play grew about 3% to roughly 3,480 reviews near 4.1; and the App Store passed 16,300 reviews at 4.6. When volume keeps rising this steadily without dragging the average down, it reads as genuine momentum rather than a solicitation push. The healthy top-line is intact. | Strong cross-platform scale: 28,790 Trustpilot reviews at ★4.16, plus iOS / Android footprints. iOS sentiment meaningfully stronger than Android, but volume itself is meaningful at this scale. | Largest review base in cohort by a wide margin — 137,169 Trustpilot reviews at ★4.59, built up in under a year of operating. Heavily invited (0.0% prompted), but volume itself is a credibility asset. | ▼ -0.5<br>Largest absolute footprint in cohort: 6,463 Trustpilot reviews at ★3.93, plus 115K iOS + 169K Android reviews. Trustpilot rating is the weakest in cohort — 6+ years of accumulation surfaces real friction. |



Sentiment & platform consistency

RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 5

▼ -0.5

Down from last week. The two stores split again this week, but the sides flipped. The App Store recovered while Google Play fell sharply — positive sentiment there dropped from 79% to 58% and one-star reviews more than doubled, from 8 to 18, driven by billing anger. The blended average still looks stable, which is the trap: Google Play is now the platform sliding, and the move is steep enough to be this week's genuine warning rather than noise.

The two stores split again this week, but the sides swapped. Where the App Store softened last week, this week it recovered and Google Play fell sharply: positive sentiment there dropped from 79% to 58%, and one-star reviews more than doubled, from 8 to 18. The blended average still looks stable, which is exactly the trap — underneath it Google Play is now the platform sliding, and the drop is steep enough to treat as this week's real signal.

LIVEN

Healthy · 7

▲ +2.5

Sentiment consistently mediocre across stores — no managed-channel cushion. Fresh App Store sentiment slipped notably, confirming a platform-wide decline rather than channel noise.

COURSIV

LEADER

Healthy · 8

▲ +3.0

Google Play sentiment is overwhelmingly positive — but Reddit is the most negative in the cohort. Sharpest managed-versus-organic gap of any brand. iOS data not available.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

▲ +2.5

iOS reads moderately positive; Android shows a near-tie between positive and negative. Fresh App Store reviews were notably worse than baseline — the worst fresh signal in the cohort.

Review authenticity signals

RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 4.8

▲ +0.3

Up from last week. The most-contested number on the board got a rare piece of good news. Last week's spike in Trustpilot compliance flags — and their shift into blunt fraud accusations — reversed: the count fell from four to one, and the single remaining flag is a routine billing information-request, not a fraud claim. The independent RealReviews tracker also edged up to 4.5 stars. The invited-review asterisk remains, but the acute scare eased this week.

Last week's alarming spike in compliance flags — and their shift to blunt fraud claims — reversed this week. The flag count fell from four to one, and the single remaining flag is a routine billing information-request on a 2-star review, not a fraud allegation. The independent tracker RealReviews also nudged up to 4.5 stars. The lasting asterisk is unchanged — about 97% of Trustpilot reviews are still company-invited — but the acute scare eased, and the score recovers a little of its lost ground.

LIVEN

Healthy · 7

92.5% of Trustpilot reviews are invited — heavier solicitation than RiseGuide but lighter than Coursiv. The iOS reply silence means iOS reviews accumulate untouched — technically more organic on that store, but also a sign of disengagement.

COURSIV

LEADER

Healthy · 8

0.0% of Trustpilot reviews are invited — the heaviest solicitation pattern in the cohort. Massive volume (137K reviews) counterbalanced by a meaningfully positive organic Reddit signal. Volume is the credibility asset; authenticity is the question mark.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Only 42.0% of Trustpilot reviews are invited — by far the most organic profile in the cohort. Six-plus years of accumulation produces a naturally diluted invited-share vs the younger heavily-prompted competitors.

## Company responsiveness to reviews

### RISEGUIDE

LEADER

Healthy · 8.3

Still the cleanest signal on the board. Every negative review on the App Store, Google Play and Trustpilot got a company reply this week, and overall reply coverage held at essentially 100% across all three. Whatever stays contested about how RiseGuide gathers its reviews, no unhappy customer is being left unanswered — a defensible, genuine strength that costs nothing to maintain and quietly underwrites the rest of the reputation story.

### LIVEN

Mixed · 4.5

Two-track operation: Trustpilot reply at 90.5%, Android Appbot 94%, but iOS reply rate 0%. Previous high score reflected Trustpilot only — once iOS visibility was added, the structural gap became the dominant signal.

### COURSIV

Healthy · 8

Trustpilot reply rate 63.5% — the lowest in cohort despite 120K reviews. Google Play reply rate is 100% including all negatives, suggesting selective engagement. iOS visibility gap is the only thing holding the score back further.

### HEADWAY

Mixed · 5.5

Previously rated highest in cohort on Trustpilot's reply rate alone (87% on Trustpilot, 90% on negatives). Fuller picture now: Android engagement is total, iOS engagement is zero. Largest single regression in the benchmark.

04

Billing Transparency

3.2/10

Headway leads this dimension at 3.9/10; RiseGuide sits at 3.2/10 (was 3.2 last week). All four brands held their dimension scores flat this week.

RiseGuide 3.2

Liven 2.9

Coursiv 3.1

Headway 3.9

Price disclosure

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>RISEGUIDELEADER</div> <div>Mixed · 4.5</div> <div>The two stores traded places this week. App Store pricing complaints held steady and their average actually improved slightly, while Google Play's pricing anger crashed — from an already-poor 2.8-star average to just 1.1 — with reviewers describing 'a premium subscription with automatic renewal at double the price... without the user having subscribed.' The relief on one store is cancelled by the collapse on the other. The recurring story is unchanged: a price users read as one-time that quietly becomes recurring.</div> | <div>LIVEN</div> <div>Critical · 3.5</div> <div>Worst pricing-disclosure exposure in the cohort — pricing complaints reached the largest cluster across all four brands. No homepage pricing; users must complete a quiz to see plans.</div> | <div>COURSIV</div> <div>Critical · 3.5</div> <div>Same quiz-funnel pattern as Liven: no upfront pricing, plans revealed at the end. Trial-to-renewal jump is the dominant friction in third-party complaints.</div> | <div>HEADWAYLEADER</div> <div>Mixed · 4.5</div> <div>Second-worst pricing-complaint exposure despite mature operations. Website FAQ links to a pricing article rather than naming prices — a transparency gap hurting otherwise solid first impressions.</div> |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## Hidden / recurring charges

### RISEGUIDE

#### Critical · 2

**Flat from last week. The worst signal on the scorecard didn't improve — it relocated. App Store payment complaints eased from 15 to 12, but Google Play's grew angrier, now averaging one star flat, with reviews reading 'they charged me double with no warning' and 'automatically renew... with no option to unsubscribe.' Total volume barely moved; the fury just changed stores. The single highest-leverage fix — an explicit charge-confirmation step before purchase — still hasn't shipped.**

Still the worst signal on the entire scorecard, and this week the anger simply relocated. App Store payment complaints eased from 15 to 12, but Google Play's grew angrier — payment reviews there now average one star flat, with language like 'they charged me double with no warning' and 'automatically renew without your consent, with no option to unsubscribe.' The total volume barely moved; what changed is which store feels robbed. The one high-leverage fix — a charge-confirmation step before purchase — still hasn't shipped.

### LIVEN

#### Critical · 2

Largest billing-flow exposure in cohort. Auto-renewal complaints are widespread across Trustpilot and unmanaged channels. Trial-to-subscription transition isn't clearly signalled — structural, not noise.

### COURSIV

#### Critical · 2

Billing-adjacent complaints come from multiple vectors at once — payment surprises and deceptive-advertising complaints both active. BBB shows billing as the dominant complaint type historically.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

#### Critical · 2.5

Significant billing-flow exposure despite mature operations. The 'HEADWAY APP IS A SCAM' Apple Communities thread persists, and unexpected weekly-premium charges after a 'free trial' remain the dominant Trustpilot 1-star theme.

## Ease of cancellation

### RISEGUIDE

#### Mixed · 4

The missing in-app cancel button is still the single mechanism tying every billing complaint together. This week's Google Play reviews repeat it almost word for word: 'no option to unsubscribe,' 'automatically renew without your consent.' The help guide still rescues whoever finds it, but it can't close the product gap that turns a billing surprise into a fraud accusation. Linking the guide from the in-app billing screen is the cheap half of the fix; a real in-app cancel path is the half that matters.

### LIVEN

#### Critical · 3.5

iOS support sentiment netted out negative, and combined with the iOS reply silence, users trying to cancel can't reach support on the largest store.

### COURSIV

#### Critical · 3.5

A third-party site publishes a dedicated 'How to Cancel Coursiv' guide — a clear signal that the native flow has enough friction to create a third-party niche.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

#### Watch · 6

Best cancellation infrastructure in cohort: published pre-renewal rule, multiple cancellation paths, no negative support-experience cluster.

## UI dark patterns

### RISEGUIDE

#### Critical · 2.3

The pattern the company itself acknowledges — charging before a clearly stated renewal date, with no email receipt — kept generating the same reviews this week, now loudest on Google Play. One relief: the compliance flags that spiked last week receded from four to one, and that one is a routine billing query rather than a fraud claim. But the perception that checkout is engineered against the user hasn't softened; it just changed which store voices it.

### LIVEN

#### Critical · 2.5

Bug complaints and pricing-flow complaints overlap — the combined cluster is the broadest in cohort. Developer publicly acknowledged manipulative rating prompts but underlying upsell flows still flagged as aggressive.

### COURSIV

#### Critical · 2.5

Deceptive-advertising complaints are a distinctive cohort marker for Coursiv. The quiz-funnel pricing reveal is a textbook dark pattern that consistently surfaces in negative reviews.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

#### Mixed · 4

Lower per-user incidence of dark-pattern complaints than peers. Apple Communities thread about misleading purchase flows persists, but the pattern is softer than what we see at Liven or Coursiv.

## Refund policy clarity & enforcement

### RISEGUIDE

#### Critical · 3

Refunds still run on negotiation, not policy. This week a Google Play customer charged twice was met by a support team 'hiding behind their policy,' while another is 'still waiting for a response regarding a refund.' With no refund policy published on the website, every outcome depends on which agent happens to answer. A clear, public refund policy remains the cheapest credibility fix anywhere in this dimension — and its absence is what keeps every refund a fresh argument.

### LIVEN

#### Critical · 3

Claimed 30-day refund policy is enforced inconsistently — some refunds granted, others refused. With the iOS reply silence, refund threads on the largest store are structurally unanswered.

### COURSIV

LEADER

#### Mixed · 4

Public Money-Back Guarantee exists but requires completing most of the program to qualify — excluding most dissatisfied users. The team engages with negatives but enforces the restriction. Documented policy is a transparency floor.

### HEADWAY

#### Critical · 2.5

No public refund policy. Apple Communities and Trustpilot threads about refund refusals on full-year charges are active. With the iOS reply silence, refund threads on iOS are structurally ignored.

05

## Brand Trust & Legitimacy

4.4/10

**Headway** leads this dimension at **7.1/10**; RiseGuide sits at **4.4/10** (was 4.4 last week). All four brands held their dimension scores flat this week.

RiseGuide 4.4

Liven 6.4

Coursiv 4.6

Headway 7.1

### Company age & history

#### RISEGUIDE

Critical · 3

Still young and still faceless. The company is roughly two years old and the app about six months, and the only public record of who runs it remains a name on business-registration filings. Time will eventually harden into credibility on its own, but the one lever available today — a real founder story attached to a real person — still hasn't been pulled, and nothing this week changed that.

#### LIVEN

Watch · 6

Around 4.5 years operating — the second-longest track record in cohort after Headway.

#### COURSIV

Critical · 3

Under a year operating, despite already having a six-figure review base. Youngest entity in cohort; review-base-to-age ratio is anomalous.

#### HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Six-plus years operating with a recent rebrand and publicly announced IPO plans. Most mature company in cohort by both operating history and corporate sophistication.



# Legal & brand identity alignment

## RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 5.3

▲ +0.3

**Up from last week. The acute legal-risk signal eased this week. The Trustpilot compliance flags that spiked to four last week — and had turned into blunt fraud accusations — fell back to a single routine billing query, and no scam-flagging site cracked the top results for 'riseguide reviews.' It's not a clean bill of health, with 'complete scam' still surfacing in reviews, but the sharpest fraud signal receded and the criterion recovers the ground it lost last week.**

The needle moved the right way this week. The Trustpilot compliance flags that spiked to four last week — and had shifted into blunt fraud accusations — fell back to a single routine billing query, and no scam-flagging site cracked the top results for 'riseguide reviews.' It's not a clean bill of health: reviewers still throw around 'complete scam' and a skeptical video persists. But the acute legal-risk signal eased, and the score recovers the ground it lost last week.

## LIVEN

Watch · 6

Corporate entity matches the consumer brand on billing and legal pages. Cyprus address publicly listed. Credibility signals in organic search results, no complaint domains ranking.

## COURSIV

Mixed · 5

Corporate entity matches the consumer brand, but search results show a concerning share of complaint pages — a billing-vector concern. No credibility-domain anchors surface.

## HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 7

Corporate entity publicly disclosed on the homepage with US registered address. Legal pages comprehensive across terms, privacy, AI usage. Forbes appears as a credibility anchor; brand-owned domains dominate first-page results.

## Third-party recognition

### RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 4.7

Independent coverage is still a real asset — several 'is it worth it?' reviews rank on the first page and the app-overview video has been seen over 316,000 times — and creator sentiment even ticked up this week. But the gap between creators and their audiences is still the story: sampled videos ran about 73% positive while their comment sections sat near 39%, one commenter warning 'Scam!!!!!! Beware!! I was charged but I could not access the app.' The scam-framed review video still holds above 15,000 views.

### LIVEN

LEADER

Watch · 6

A Board of Health Professionals page lists 15+ named PhDs — a distinctive scientific-credibility signal. YouTube coverage is healthy with almost no complaint-framed videos. Crunchbase appears in search.

### COURSIV

LEADER

Watch · 6

Listed on Tracxn and Crunchbase, with broad YouTube creator coverage. But organic search results skew complaint-heavy, and there's no editorial press coverage from Forbes, TechCrunch, or peer outlets.

### HEADWAY

Mixed · 4.5

Strongest third-party recognition stack: Wikipedia, Endeavor entrepreneur backing, recurring trade press around IPO plans, and YouTube creator coverage unanimously positive.

## Leadership transparency

### RISEGUIDE

Critical · 3

The longest-running flat line in the report, and still the biggest free win. No founder bio, no About page, no leadership presence anywhere in this week's search results — again — while reviewers openly accuse the brand of fraud. The absence of a named, photographed person to stand behind the product isn't a missing nicety; it's the void those accusations rush to fill. A short founder bio with a real photo remains the single highest score-per-effort fix anywhere in this scorecard.

### LIVEN

Healthy · 7

Founder publicly named, and an extensive list of health-professional advisors published by name and credential. Leadership identity transparent and verifiable.

### COURSIV

Critical · 3

No founders or executives publicly named anywhere — website, registry filings, or LinkedIn. Anonymous-corporate posture despite a very large customer base — a distinctive cohort outlier.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Founder is public with extensive media presence — interviews, Endeavor profile, recurring press around the IPO. Strongest leadership transparency stack in cohort.

## Online presence consistency

### RISEGUIDE

Watch · 6

▼ -0.3

**Down from last week. Last week's search-footprint gain gave some ground back. Company-owned pages slipped from six of the top thirty results to five, and the skeptical Reddit thread — 'Has anyone tried riseguide.com?' — climbed back into the top results after dropping out last week. RiseGuide controls slightly less of its own search real estate this week, and a doubter's voice sits higher in it than it did seven days ago.**

Last week's search-footprint gain gave some ground back. Company-owned pages slipped from six of the top thirty results to five, and the skeptical Reddit thread — 'Has anyone tried riseguide.com?' — climbed back into the top results after dropping out last week. Where RiseGuide controls the message the branding stays perfectly consistent across the website, both stores and Trustpilot; but this week it controls slightly less of the search real estate, and a doubter's voice sits higher in it.

### LIVEN

Healthy · 7

Consistent branding across web, app stores, and Trustpilot. Official Health Professional Board page reinforces brand identity. Corporate address publicly displayed.

### COURSIV

Watch · 6

Branding consistent across visible channels, but corporate and leadership data largely absent — undermines coherence at the trust layer. Organic search shows a concerning complaint-page share.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Wikipedia, Crunchbase, official About-us, press coverage, and store listings all reinforce the same brand and corporate identity. Search results contain the broadest unique-domain set in cohort.

## 3 IDEAS · NEXT WEEK

# Initiatives that would lift the score

**01 Publish an About-us page with founder bio**

**LIFTS:** LEADERSHIP TRANSPARENCY · 3.0 → ~5 · Single content page — one photo, four links. Ship by Friday.

Liven publicly names CEO Shahrooz Chowdhury + 15 PhD advisors — scores 7. Headway publicly names founder Anton Pavlovsky with press coverage — scores 8.

**How to ship**

- 1 Commission a clean headshot of Oleksandr Matsiuk + draft a 2-paragraph bio (background + why RiseGuide exists)
- 2 Publish at [riseguide.com/about](https://riseguide.com/about) with photo, bio, and a LinkedIn link
- 3 Link the page from the homepage footer and the App Store / Google Play developer pages

**02 Publish an explicit refund + cancellation policy**

**LIFTS:** REFUND POLICY 3.0 → 4+ · EASE OF CANCELLATION 4.3 → 5+ · Policy page + reply templates — text only, no engineering. Ship by Wednesday.

Headway's published 24-hour pre-renewal rule anchors their 6.0 score on cancellation (best in cohort). Coursiv's public Money-Back Guarantee anchors their 4.0 on refund policy.

**How to ship**

- 1 Write a 1-page policy: **7-day no-questions refund + 24-hour pre-renewal cancel rule**
- 2 Publish at [riseguide.com/refunds](https://riseguide.com/refunds), link from the footer and every billing email
- 3 Update support reply templates + cross-link from in-app billing + store descriptions

**03 Publish a 'How your subscription works' explainer**

**LIFTS:** HIDDEN CHARGES 2.0 → 3+ · PRICE DISCLOSURE 5.0 → 6+ · Support article + email-template update. Text-only, no engineering, no funnel impact. Ship by Wednesday.

Reviewers report surprise at the first payment amount, but the underlying model (introductory discount, then renewal at full price) is industry-standard. The complaint is about clarity of communication, not the pricing itself.

**How to ship**

- 1 Write a plain-English article: **introductory price + when full price kicks in + how to cancel**
- 2 Publish at [support.riseguide.com/how-pricing-works](https://support.riseguide.com/how-pricing-works), link from every billing email + App Store description
- 3 Update support reply templates to cite the article URL on every billing-surprise thread